

CODE RESCUE

Three-Round Debugging Challenge

Think. Debug. Fix. Rescue the Code!

EVENT PROPOSAL

Staff Coordinators

Dr. G. Senthil Velan
Ms. Anu

Student Coordinators

Kavitha G
Sanjai P.A.
Yashvinthan M

Submitted for approval

1. Event Overview

Code Rescue is a three-round debugging competition designed to test participants' programming knowledge, debugging ability, logical thinking, accuracy, speed, analysis, and problem-solving skills. Participants are presented with faulty programs and must identify errors, understand the cause, correct the code, test the solution, and submit the expected result within the allotted time.

The event follows a progressive structure in which the challenge increases from basic debugging to advanced debugging. Participants who qualify in one round proceed to the next round.

Core Event Flow

Registration → Rules Briefing → Round 1: Bug Hunt → Qualification → Round 2: Logic Breaker → Qualification → Round 3: Code Rescue → Final Evaluation → Results

2. Objectives

- Provide students with a competitive platform to demonstrate programming and debugging skills.
- Test the ability to identify and correct syntax, logical, and runtime errors.
- Develop analytical thinking and problem-solving under time constraints.
- Evaluate accuracy and efficiency while debugging programs.
- Encourage practical understanding of code execution and error handling.
- Create an engaging technical event based on progressive difficulty.

3. Eligibility & Participation

- The event is open to registered students/participants.
- Each participant may register only once.
- Participants must carry a valid college/student ID.
- Participation is individual.

Note: The uploaded rules establish registration and ID requirements. The individual participation format is included here as the proposed event structure.

4. Event Format

The competition consists of three progressive rounds. Each round has a fixed time limit. Only participants who qualify in a round proceed to the next round. The difficulty increases from basic to advanced.

Round	Name	Focus	Difficulty
1	Bug Hunt	Syntax errors, missing statements, basic mistakes	Basic
2	Logic Breaker	Logical errors, runtime errors, correct output	Intermediate
3	Code Rescue	Complete debugging of a challenging broken program	Advanced

5. Round 1 — BUG HUNT

Bug Hunt is the introductory round. Participants receive short faulty programs and must identify and fix basic errors. The round focuses on syntax errors, missing statements, and simple programming mistakes.

Proposed operating format

Item	Proposed Format
Duration	20 minutes
Questions	10
Points	10 points per question; 100 points maximum
Difficulty	Basic
Focus	Syntax, missing statements, basic functions, variables, conditions and simple loops

Participant task: Read the faulty code → identify the error → correct it → run/test → submit.

6. Round 2 — LOGIC BREAKER

Logic Breaker increases the complexity. Participants debug programs containing logical and runtime errors and determine the correct output. The round tests whether participants can understand why a program behaves incorrectly rather than only finding obvious syntax errors.

Proposed operating format

Item	Proposed Format
Duration	25 minutes
Questions	5
Points	20 points per question; 100 points maximum
Difficulty	Intermediate
Focus	Logic errors, runtime errors, loops, conditions, functions, incorrect outputs and edge cases

7. Round 3 — CODE RESCUE

Code Rescue is the final and most challenging round. Participants receive a larger broken program containing multiple types of errors. They must understand the program, identify the bugs, correct the code, test the solution, handle edge cases, and submit the correct solution within the time limit.

Proposed operating format

Item	Proposed Format
Duration	40 minutes
Challenge	1 major debugging problem
Points	100 points
Difficulty	Advanced

8. Submission & Evaluation

Participants will edit and submit their own code. Programs will be evaluated using test cases, including hidden test cases. The evaluation should verify correctness and, where applicable, execution/time efficiency.

- Participants may run/test their code before submission.
- A submission is evaluated against the defined test cases.
- Hidden test cases may be used to verify general correctness.
- The exact input/output format specified for each problem must be followed.
- Submissions must be made before the round deadline.

9. Scoring & Qualification

The rules identify correctness, execution/time efficiency, problem-solving approach, and timely submission as scoring considerations. The following point structure is proposed to make the competition easy to conduct and understand.

Round	Maximum Score
Round 1	100
Round 2	100
Round 3	100
Total possible across completed rounds	300

Qualification: The exact number/percentage of participants progressing from each round should be finalized by the coordinator based on the registered participant count. A configurable qualification threshold or top-performer cutoff can be used.

Tie-breaker: The existing rules permit earlier submission time or lower execution time to be used as tie-breakers. The final order should be announced before the event.

10. Rules & Regulations

- Participants must write and submit their own code.
- Only programming languages announced by the organizers are permitted.
- Programs must follow the specified input/output format.
- Correctness, efficiency and completion within the time limit will be considered.
- Participants must submit before the announced deadline.
- Multiple submissions may be allowed depending on the round; any penalties must be announced in advance.
- In case of technical issues, participants must immediately inform the event coordinators.

11. AI & External Assistance Policy

For this proposed version of Code Rescue, AI/code-generation assistance will not be permitted. The restriction is intended to preserve the debugging and problem-solving focus of the competition.

- ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, GitHub Copilot and other AI/code-generation tools are prohibited.
- Copying code from another participant or external solution is prohibited.
- Communication with other participants during the coding round is prohibited.
- Unauthorized websites, notes, devices or external assistance are prohibited.
- Plagiarism or malpractice may result in immediate disqualification.

12. Disqualification

- Use of unauthorized AI or external assistance.
- Plagiarism or copied code.
- Communication during the competition.
- Tampering with the contest system.
- Misconduct or violation of organizer instructions.
- Use of any unfair means.

13. Technical Issue Handling

If a participant experiences a technical problem, the participant must immediately notify the event coordinator/invigilator. The technical team should verify the issue and record the incident. Any action concerning time or system replacement should follow a predefined organizer procedure.

14. Participant Journey

Step	Participant Action
1	Register for the event
2	Report to venue 15–30 minutes before the event
3	Complete ID verification and seating
4	Attend rules briefing
5	Attempt Bug Hunt
6	Check qualification result
7	Attempt Logic Breaker if qualified
8	Check qualification result
9	Attempt Code Rescue if qualified
10	Receive final evaluation and ranking

15. Organizer Responsibilities

- Event Coordinator / Event Head — overall coordination and final administrative decisions.

- Technical Team — coding platform, systems, compiler/runtime environment and technical support.
- Question Team — preparation, testing and validation of questions and test cases.
- Judges — scoring, qualification, disputes, penalties and disqualification decisions.
- Invigilators — participant monitoring and rule enforcement.
- Registration Team — participant registration, attendance and ID verification.
- Help Desk / Support — participant assistance and issue coordination.

16. Pre-Event Preparation

- Finalize participant capacity and registration process.
- Finalize programming language(s).
- Prepare and review questions for all three rounds.
- Create visible and hidden test cases.
- Test every problem using the intended judging environment.
- Finalize qualification thresholds or participant cutoffs.
- Prepare participant instructions and judge instructions.
- Test all computers, network restrictions and contest platform.
- Conduct a full mock run before the event.

17. Proposed Event-Day Schedule

Activity	Proposed Duration
Registration & verification	15 minutes
Rules briefing	10 minutes
Round 1 — Bug Hunt	20 minutes
Round 1 evaluation / transition	10 minutes
Round 2 — Logic Breaker	25 minutes
Round 2 evaluation / transition	10 minutes
Round 3 — Code Rescue	40 minutes
Final evaluation	10–15 minutes
Results / prize distribution	10–15 minutes

The exact schedule should be adjusted according to the number of participants and the available event slot.

18. Technical Requirements

- Computer systems for participants, preferably organizer-provided systems.
- Stable local network / internet configuration as required by the selected platform.
- Coding environment and required compiler/interpreter.

- Contest/judging platform or prototype system.
- Projector/display for instructions and announcements.
- Technical support personnel.
- Backup systems and contingency procedure for technical failures.

19. Expected Outcomes

- Participants gain practical debugging experience.
- Students demonstrate programming and analytical skills in a competitive setting.
- The event encourages accuracy and time management.
- Participants learn to identify syntax, logical and runtime issues systematically.
- The competition provides an engaging technical activity for students.

20. Approval Request

We request approval to conduct Code Rescue as a three-round technical debugging competition. The event is designed to provide students with an engaging and practical platform to demonstrate programming, debugging, analytical and problem-solving abilities.

Prepared by	_____
Student / Team	_____
Faculty Coordinator	_____
Department	_____
Proposed Date	_____
Venue	_____
Coordinator Signature	_____
Date	_____

Note on proposed elements: The uploaded Code Rescue documents establish the core three-round concept, round descriptions, eligibility, rules, anti-cheating requirements, submission principles, scoring considerations, disqualification and conduct rules. Specific durations, question counts, point allocations and qualification thresholds in this proposal are proposed implementation details for coordinator approval.